# UPFRONT

**GLASSHOUSE:** SKILL DEFICIENCIES *PG 12*

**MUMBAI:** THE NEW BIG BROTHER *PG 16*



**WELCOME ABOARD** PM Modi with new BJP president Nitin Nabin at the party HQ, Jan. 20

ATUL KUMAR YADAV

▶ BJP

# BIG SHOES TO FILL

**The BJP gets its youngest president as the party hints at generational change. But there will be no idling time, Nitin Nabin will have to hit the road running**

By ANILESH S. MAHAJAN

**ON JANUARY 20, THE BHARATIYA JANATA PARTY (BJP) FORMALLY ELECTED NITIN NABIN** as its new national president, marking the culmination of a high-stakes, 13-month-long search for a name acceptable to all sides involved in the consultations. The choice was telling—at just 45, Nabin is the youngest to take charge of what is touted as the world's largest political organisation.

The party's parliamentary board had appointed him working president in mid-December. A five-time MLA from Bihar's Bankipur constituency and minister in the Nitish Kumar-led cabinet there, Nabin has now been catapulted to the national stage. The election process was a mere formality; all 37 sets of nomination papers had